

missing presentation tool, Ability Office has all the tools required for day-to-day office tasks.

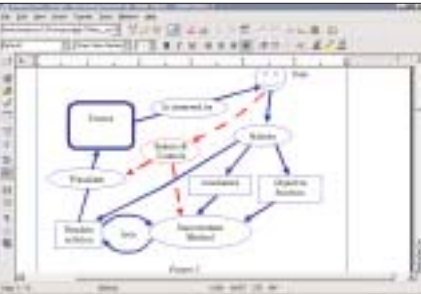
Corel WordPerfect 11: Corel WordPerfect consists of three components—WordPerfect 11 is the word processor, Quattro Pro 11 is the spreadsheet tool and Presentations is the presentation tool.

Lotus SmartSuite 9.8: Lotus SmartSuite consists of a group of applications that also include office software. The office components include Lotus 1-2-3, WordPro and FreeLance Graphics. Apart from these, the other applications included are Lotus SmartManager, an information management tool; Lotus Approach, a database; Fastsite, a Web publishing application; and a time management tool called Lotus Organizer.

WORD PROCESSORS

StarOffice 7 Writer
Star of formatting

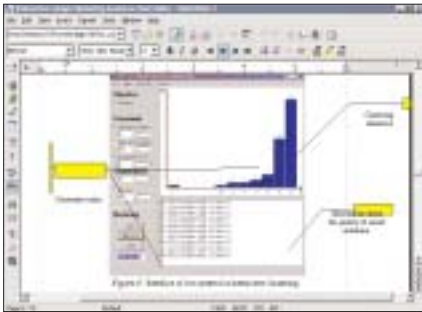
StarOffice Writer offered the best compatibility with MS Word documents. While the displayed text was not as crisp as in MS Word, there were very little formatting errors. It was also able to display a majority of the images and diagrams in the test documents. Strangely though, it had problems displaying some of the



StarOffice Writer managed to display almost all the embedded images, with decent quality



In spite of its good compatibility, StarOffice missed out on some of the diagrams



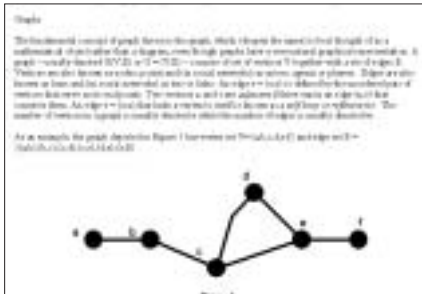
Callouts on embedded screenshots were not displayed properly

simple images that were similar to the ones it displayed perfectly. It also had problems displaying a majority of the callouts on the screenshots.

Ability Write:
Symbolically handicapped

Ability Write has good compatibility with documents that are a simple mix of text and images. The displayed text and formatting in Write was more or less similar to the one in the original document opened in MS Office, except that a few symbols were changed at some places. But it did have trouble displaying paragraph headings with exactly the same formatting.

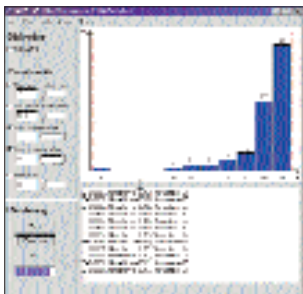
But there were other problems too. Ability Write couldn't properly align the bullet lists in some of the test documents, and had a problem displaying footnotes. The footnotes were displayed at the place



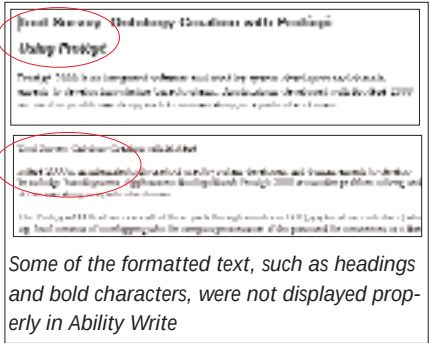
The text formatting and displayed images were generally good, except for headings and a few formulas



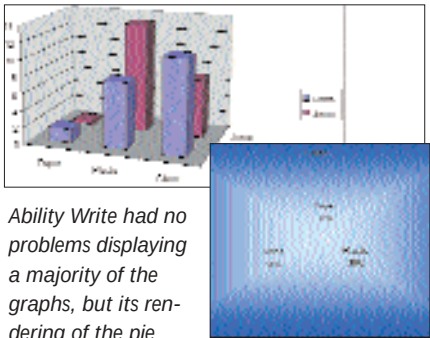
Footnotes were displayed in place, in between the text, instead of at the bottom of the page



The callout in this image was not visible in Ability Write



Some of the formatted text, such as headings and bold characters, were not displayed properly in Ability Write



Ability Write had no problems displaying a majority of the graphs, but its rendering of the pie chart was not satisfactory

of reference, rather than at the end of the page. A majority of the embedded images, too, were not displayed.

While bullet lists just had problems with alignment, the numbers in numbered lists were simply not incremente—it showed '1, 2, 3' as '1, 1, 1'. One of the few images that were displayed didn't have proper labelling in place.

A peculiar problem observed in Ability office was that after continuously opening and closing a few documents, it could not open any more documents—they all opened up as blank documents. Restarting the application solved the problem. At places it had problems with formatting, it displayed several headings as normal text.

Ability Write could not hold it all together in a good way. While it displayed a majority of the embedded images and screenshots, it could not give the documents the same effect that MS Word gives. Overall, this is a product that